

Free Scene "Prom Night" by Jonathan Dorf

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Prom Night

From [The Throne Room](#)

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(A high school bathroom. Several stalls, and perhaps some urinals we don't need to see. The door to the bathroom swings open. Enter JAKE, 18 and wearing some version of a tux. MUSIC streams in through the open door. Beat.)

JAKE

Sawyer?

(SAWYER, same age, calls out from inside one of the stalls. We probably see his ankles, but that's about it.)

SAWYER

In here.

JAKE

Are you OK?

SAWYER

I guess. Did Mara send you?

JAKE

Nah. She's fingerpainting slash dancing with the cheerleaders. I told her Isaac spiked the punch, and now she thinks she's drunk.

SAWYER

Isaac didn't spike the punch?

JAKE

McGovern.

SAWYER

He caught him?

JAKE

They had "the moment."

SAWYER

(Doing Mr. McGovern:)

"I know you're going to be one of the good ones."

JAKE

Isaac cracked like a nacho.

SAWYER

It won't last.

JAKE

Just long enough for the punch bowl to stay virgin for one night.

(Beat.)

I think it's one of those mass suggestion things, 'cause everybody's dancing sloppy drunk and rubbing themselves with paint and I know pretty much for a fact they're stone cold sober.

(Beat.)

You should come see it.

SAWYER

Is Tulip finger dancing?

JAKE

Yeah. She was with Mara when I left. Supposedly it washes out.

SAWYER

Cool. Never saw this trend coming.

JAKE

Me neither, and to think they started it at our school. Crazy.

(Beat.)

So are you like...like what's up?

SAWYER

What do you mean?

JAKE

It's been 20 minutes.

SAWYER

Really?

JAKE

(Checking his phone:)

Actually, 21 now. So what's up?

SAWYER

It's seriously 21 minutes.

JAKE

Yes.

SAWYER

Like you're actually timing me?

JAKE

You know I can't help it. But yeah.

SAWYER

Doesn't that make you nuts to look at something once and know it's gonna be stuck in your head for months?

JAKE

Don't change the subject.

SAWYER

But doesn't it?

JAKE

Yes, but seriously, are you sick or something?

SAWYER

I'm good.

JAKE

Sawyer, please tell me you're not doing what I think you're doing.

SAWYER

Ugh. No. How could you think I'm—

JAKE

You're alone in a stall for 21 minutes—you are alone, right?

SAWYER

Oh my god, Jake!

JAKE

Sorry.

SAWYER

I'm just...thinking.

JAKE

Like actually thinking.

(Beat.)

Thinking isn't some new code for—

SAWYER

No! I'm contemplating my life.

JAKE

Are you dying?

SAWYER

Why would you think I'm dying?

JAKE

People don't contemplate their lives at prom.

SAWYER

(Beat.)

I'm not into Mara.

JAKE

Well, it's just a prom date.

SAWYER

No. Like I'm not into Mara's type.

(Pause.)

As in the female type.

JAKE

... Oh.

SAWYER

Contemplating.

JAKE

You can't tell Mara tonight.

SAWYER

Of course not.

(Beat.)

I think I've known since that time in seventh grade when my mom completely spaced on picking me up after soccer and you and your mom gave me a ride home and I was crying, which was totally embarrassing, and you squeezed my shoulder and I jumped and spilled my Coke on your sweats.

(Sawyer steps out of the stall, also wearing some version of a tux. Beat.)

JAKE

Crap.

(Jake goes into another stall.)

SAWYER

Jake?

JAKE
(Beat.)

This is like the world's biggest coincidence. I too have been contemplating.

SAWYER

...

(Beat.)
I thought you and Tulip were serious.

JAKE

I guess not.

SAWYER

You can't tell her tonight.

JAKE

Of course not.

SAWYER

(Beat.)
Wait. When you said—wait.

(Sawyer goes back into his original stall.)

SAWYER

When you said you were contemplating, were you contemplating someone in particular?

JAKE

Were you?

(Beat. Both stall doors open. Jake and Sawyer face each other. Beat.)

SAWYER

What do we do now?

JAKE

I'm gonna wash my hands. That stall is gross.